6.4.2 Frequency Polygon

A frequency polygon is a line graph for the graphical representation of the frequency distribution. If we mark the midpoints on the top of the rectangles in a histogram and join them by straight lines, the figure so formed is called a frequency polygon. It is called a polygon as it consists of a number of lines as the sides of a polygon.

A frequency polygon is useful in comparing two or more frequency distributions. A frequency polygon for a grouped frequency distribution can be constructed in two ways.

i) Using a histogram
ii) Without using a histogram

6.4.2 (i) To construct a frequency polygon using a histogram:

1. Draw a histogram from the given data.
2. Join the consecutive midpoints of the upper sides of the adjacent rectangles of the histogram by the line segments.
3. It is assumed that the class interval preceding the first rectangle and the class interval succeeding the last rectangle exists in the histogram and the frequency of each extreme class interval is zero. These class intervals are known as imagined class intervals.
4. To get frequency polygon, join the midpoints of these imagined classes with the corresponding midpoints of the upper sides of the first and last rectangles of the histogram.

Example 6.9

The following is the distribution of time spent in the library by students in a school.

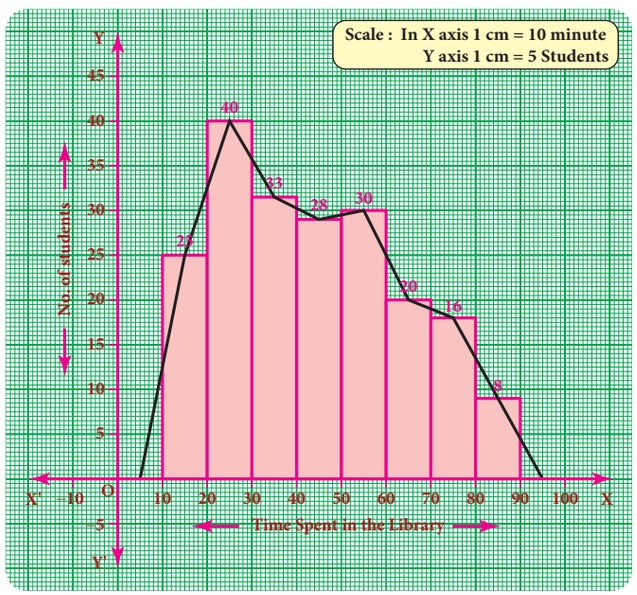
Time spent (in minutes)	10-20	20-30	30-40	40-50	50-60	60-70	70-80	80-90
Number of Students	25	40	33	28	30	20	16	8

Draw a frequency polygon using histogram.

Solution:

Represent the time spent in the library along x- axis and number of students along the y–axis.

Draw a histogram for the given data. Now, mark the midpoints of the upper sides of the consecutive rectangles. Also mark the midpoints of two imagined class intervals 0-10 and 90-100 whose frequency is 0 on x- axis. Now, join all the midpoints with the help of ruler. We get a frequency polygon imposed on the histogram.



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